

The Poor

Made by God.

Job 34:19 How much less to him that accepteth not the persons of Princes, nor regardeth the rich more than the poor? for they all are the work of his hands.

Proverbs 22:2 The rich and poor meet together: the LORD is the maker of them all.

Are such by God's appointment.

1 Samuel 2:7 The LORD maketh poor, and maketh rich: he bringeth low, and lifteth up.

Job 1:21 And said, Naked came I out of my mother's womb, and naked shall I return thither: the LORD gave, and the LORD hath taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.

CONDITION OF, OFTEN RESULTS FROM

Sloth.

Proverbs 20:13 Love not sleep, lest thou come to poverty; open thine eyes, and thou shalt be satisfied with bread.

Bad company.

Proverbs 28:19 He that tilleth his land shall have plenty of bread: but he that followeth after vain persons shall have poverty enough.

Drunkenness and gluttony.

Proverbs 23:21 For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty: and drowsiness shall clothe a man with rags.

GOD

Regards, equally with the rich.

Job 34:19 How much less to him that accepteth not the persons of Princes, nor regardeth the rich more than the poor? for they all are the work of his hands.

Forgets not.

Psalm 9:18 For the needy shall not alway be forgotten: the expectation of the poor shall not perish for ever.

Hears.

Psalm 69:33 For the LORD heareth the poor, and despiseth not his prisoners.

Isaiah 41:17 When the poor and needy seek water, and there is none, and their tongue faileth for thirst, I the LORD will hear them, I the God of Israel will not forsake them.

Maintains the right of.

Psalm 140:12 I know that the LORD will maintain the cause of the Afflicted, and the right of the poor.

Delivers.

Job 36:15 He delivereth the poor in his Affliction, and openeth their ears in oppression.

Psalm 35:10 All my bones shall say, LORD, who is like unto thee, which deliverest the poor from him that is too strong for him, yea, the poor and the needy from him that spoileth him?

Protects.

Psalm 12:5 For the oppression of the poor, for the sighing of the needy, now will I arise, saith the LORD; I will set him in safety from him that puffeth at him.

Psalm 109:31 For he shall stand at the right hand of the poor, to save him from those that condemn his soul.

Exalts.

1 Samuel 2:8 He raiseth up the poor out of the dust, and lifteth up the beggar from the dunghill, to set them among Princes, and to make them inherit the throne of glory: for the pillars of the earth are the LORDS', and he hath set the world upon them.

Psalm 107:41 Yet setteth he the poor on high from Affliction, and maketh him families like a flock.

Provides for.

Psalm 68:10 Thy Congregation hath dwelt therein: thou, O God, hast prepared of thy goodness for the poor.

Psalm 146:7 Which executeth Judgment for the oppressed: which giveth food to the hungry. The LORD looseth the prisoners:

Despises not the prayer of.

Psalm 102:17 He will regard the prayer of the destitute, and not despise their prayer.

Is the refuge of.

Psalm 14:6 Ye have shamed the counsel of the poor, because the LORD is his refuge.

Shall never cease out of the land.

Deuteronomy 15:11 For the poor shall never cease out of the land: therefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy, in thy land.

Zephaniah 3:12 I will also leave in the midst of thee an Afflicted and poor people, and they shall trust in the name of the LORD.

Matthew 26:11 For ye have the poor always with you; but me ye have not always.

MAY BE

Rich in Faith.

James 2:5 Hearken, my beloved Brethren, Hath not God Chosen the poor of this world rich in Faith, and heirs of the kingdom which he hath promised to them that love him?

Liberal.

Mark 12:42 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing.

2 Corinthians 9:12 For the administration of this service not only supplieth the want of the Saints, but is abundant also by many thanksgivings unto God;

Wise.

Proverbs 28:11 The rich man is wise in his own conceit; but the poor that hath understanding searcheth him out.

Upright.

Proverbs 19:1 Better is the poor that walketh in his integrity, than he that is perverse in his lips, and is a fool.

Christ lived as one of.

Matthew 8:20 And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air have nests; but The Son Of Man hath not where to lay his head.

Christ preached to.

Luke 4:18 The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he hath anointed me to preach the Gospel to the poor; he hath sent me to heal the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to the captives, and recovering of sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised,

Christ delivers.

Psalm 72:12 For he shall deliver the needy when he crieth; the poor also, and him that hath no helper.

Offerings of, acceptable to God.

Mark 12:42-44 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing. And he called *unto him* his disciples, and saith unto them, **Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury: For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.**

2 Corinthians 8:2 How that in a great trial of affliction the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their liberality.

2 Corinthians 8:12 For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not.

SHOULD

Rejoice in God.

Isaiah 29:19 The meek also shall increase their joy in the LORD, and the poor among men shall rejoice in the Holy One of Israel.

Hope in God.

Job 5:16 So the poor hath hope, and iniquity stoppeth her mouth.

Commit themselves to God.

Psalm 10:14 Thou hast seen it; for thou beholdest mischief and spite, to requite it with thy hand: the poor committeth himself unto thee; thou Art the helper of the Fatherless.

When converted, rejoice in their exaltation.

James 1:9 Let the brother of low degree rejoice in that he is exalted:

Provided for under The Law.

Exodus 23:11 But the seventh year thou shalt let it rest and lie still; that the poor of thy people may eat: and what they leave the beasts of the field shall eat. In like manner thou shalt deal with thy vineyard, and with thy oliveyard.

Leviticus 19:9-10 And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not wholly reap the corners of thy field, neither shalt thou gather the gleanings of thy harvest. And thou shalt not glean thy vineyard, neither shalt thou gather every grape of thy vineyard; thou shalt leave them for the poor and stranger: I am the LORD your God.

NEGLECT TOWARDS, IS

A neglect of Christ.

Matthew 25:42-45 For I was an hungred, and ye gave me no meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me no drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me not in: naked, and ye clothed me not: sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not. Then shall they also answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, or athirst, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and did not minister unto thee? Then shall he answer them, saying, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye did it not to one of the least of these, ye did it not to me.

Inconsistent with love to God.

1 John 3:17 But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother have need, and

shutteth up his Bowels of compassion from him, how dwelleth the love of God in him?

A proof of unbelief.

James 2:15-17 If a brother or sister be naked, and destitute of daily food, And one of you say unto them, Depart in peace, be ye warmed and filled; notwithstanding ye give them not those things which are needful to the body; what doth it profit? Even so Faith, if it hath not works, is dead, being alone.

Rob not.

Proverbs 22:22 Rob not the poor, because he is poor: neither oppress the Afflicted in the gate:

Wrong not in Judgment.

Exodus 23:6 Thou shalt not wrest the Judgment of thy poor in his cause.

Take no usury from.

Leviticus 25:36 Take thou no usury of him, or increase: but fear thy God; that thy brother may live with thee.

Harden not the heart against.

Deuteronomy 15:7 If there be among you a poor man of one of thy Brethren within any of thy gates in thy land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, thou shalt not harden thine heart, nor shut thine hand from thy poor brother:

Shut not the hand against.

Deuteronomy 15:7 If there be among you a poor man of one of thy Brethren within any of thy gates in thy land which the LORD thy God giveth thee, thou shalt not harden thine heart, nor shut thine hand from thy poor brother:

Rule not, with rigor.

Leviticus 25:39 And if thy brother that dwelleth by thee be waxen poor, and be sold unto thee; thou shalt not compel him to serve as a bondservant:

Leviticus 25:43 Thou shalt not rule over him with rigour; but shalt fear thy God.

Oppress not.

Deuteronomy 24:14 Thou shalt not oppress an hired Servant that is poor and needy, whether he be of thy Brethren, or of thy strangers that are in thy land within thy gates:

Zechariah 7:10 And oppress not the widow, nor the Fatherless, the stranger, nor the poor; and let none of you imagine evil against his brother in your heart.

Despise not.

Proverbs 14:21 He that despiseth his neighbour Sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.

James 2:2-4 For if there come unto your assembly a man with a gold ring, in goodly apparel, and there come in also a poor man in vile raiment; And ye have respect to him that weareth the gay clothing, and say unto him, Sit thou here in a good place; and say to the poor, Stand thou there, or sit here under my footstool: Are ye not then partial in yourselves, and are become Judges of evil thoughts?

Relieve.

Leviticus 25:35 And if thy brother be waxen poor, and fallen in decay with thee; then thou shalt relieve him: yea, though he be a stranger, or a sojourner; that he may live with thee.

Matthew 19:21 Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.

Defend.

Psalm 82:3-4 Defend the poor and Fatherless: do justice to the Afflicted and needy. Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked.

Do justice to.

Psalm 82:3 Defend the poor and Fatherless: do justice to the Afflicted and needy.

Jeremiah 22:3 Thus saith the LORD; Execute ye Judgment and righteousness, and deliver the spoiled out of the hand of the oppressor: and do no wrong, do no violence to the stranger, the Fatherless, nor the widow, neither shed innocent blood in this place.

Jeremiah 22:16 He judged the cause of the poor and needy; then it was well with him: was not this to know me? saith the LORD.

A CARE FOR,

Is characteristic of Saints.

Psalm 112:9 He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; his righteousness endureth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.

2 Corinthians 9:9 (As it is written, He hath dispersed abroad; he hath given to the poor: his righteousness remaineth for ever.

Proverbs 29:7 The Righteous considereth the cause of the poor: but the wicked regardeth not to know it.

Is a fruit of repentance.

Luke 3:11 He answereth and saith unto them, He that hath two Coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.

Should be urged.

2 Corinthians 8:7-8 Therefore, as ye abound in every thing, in Faith, and utterance, and knowledge, and in all diligence, and in your love to us, see that ye abound in this grace also. I speak not by commandment, but by occasion of the forwardness of others, and to prove the sincerity of your love.

GIVE TO,

Not grudgingly.

Deuteronomy 15:10 Thou shalt surely give him, and thine heart shall not be grieved when thou givest unto him: because that for this thing the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thy works, and in all that thou puttest thine hand unto.

2 Corinthians 9:7 Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.

Liberally.

Deuteronomy 14:29 And the Levite, (because he hath no part nor inheritance with thee,) and the stranger, and the Fatherless, and the widow, which are within thy gates, shall come, and shall eat and be satisfied; that the LORD thy God may bless thee in all the work of thine hand which thou doest.

Deuteronomy 15:8 But thou shalt open thine hand wide unto him, and shalt surely lend him sufficient for his need, in that which he wanteth.

Deuteronomy 15:11 For the poor shall never cease out of the land: therefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy, in thy land.

Cheerfully.

2 Corinthians 8:12 For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not.

2 Corinthians 9:7 Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.

Without ostentation.

Matthew 6:1 Take heed that ye do not your Alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven.

Specially if Saints.

Romans 12:13 Distributing to the necessity of Saints; given to hospitality.

Galatians 6:10 As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of Faith.

Pray for.

Psalm 74:19 O deliver not the soul of thy turtledove unto the multitude of the wicked: forget not the Congregation of thy poor for ever.

Psalm 74:21 O let not the oppressed return ashamed: let the poor and needy praise thy name.

THEY WHO IN FAITH, BELIEVE,

Are happy.

Proverbs 14:21 He that despiseth his neighbour Sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.

Are blessed.

Deuteronomy 15:10 Thou shalt surely give him, and thine heart shall not be grieved when thou givest unto him: because that for this thing the LORD thy God shall bless thee in all thy works, and in all that thou puttest thine hand unto.

Psalm 41:1 Blessed is he that considereth the poor: the LORD will deliver him in time of trouble.

Proverbs 22:9 He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; for he giveth of his bread to the poor.

Acts 20:35 I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.

Have the favor of God.

Hebrews 13:16 But to do good and to Communicate forget not: for with such sacrifices God is well pleased.

Have promises.

Proverbs 28:27 He that giveth unto the poor shall not lack: but he that hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.

Luke 14:13-14 But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame, the blind: And thou shalt be blessed; for they cannot recompense thee: for thou shalt be recompensed at the resurrection of the just.

By oppressing, God is reproached.

Proverbs 14:31 He that oppresseth the poor reproacheth his Maker: but he that honoureth him hath mercy on the poor.

By mocking, God is reproached.

Proverbs 17:5 Whoso mocketh the poor reproacheth his Maker: and he that is glad at calamities shall not be unpunished.

THE WICKED

Care not for.

John 12:6 This he said, not that he cared for the poor; but because he was a thief, and had the bag, and bare what was put therein.

Oppress.

Job 24:4-10 They turn the needy out of the way: the poor of the earth hide themselves together. Behold, as wild asses in the desert, go they forth to their work; rising Betimes for a prey: the wilderness yieldeth food for them and for their children. They reap every one his Corn in the field: and they gather the vintage of the wicked. They cause the naked to lodge without clothing, that they have no covering in the cold. ...

Ezekiel 18:12 Hath oppressed the poor and needy, hath spoiled by violence, hath not restored the pledge, and hath lifted up his eyes to the Idols, hath committed Abomination,

Vex.

Ezekiel 22:20 As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin, into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so will I gather you in mine Anger and in my fury, and I will leave you there, and melt you.

Regard not the cause of.

Proverbs 29:7 The Righteous considereth the cause of the poor: but the wicked regardeth not to know it.

Sell.

Amos 2:6 Thus saith the LORD; For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn away the punishment thereof; because they sold the Righteous for silver, and the poor for a pair of shoes;

Crush.

Amos 4:1 Hear this word, ye kine of Bashan, that are in the mountain of Samaria, which oppress the poor, which crush the needy, which say to their masters, Bring, and let us drink.

Tread down.

Amos 5:11 Forasmuch therefore as your treading is upon the poor, and ye take from him burdens of wheat: ye have built houses of hewn stone, but ye shall not dwell in them; ye have planted pleasant vineyards, but ye shall not drink wine of them.

Grind the faces of.

Isaiah 3:15 What mean ye that ye beat my people to pieces, and grind the faces of the poor? saith the Lord GOD of hosts.

Devour.

Habakkuk 3:14 Thou didst strike through with his staves the head of his villages: they came out as a whirlwind to scatter me: their rejoicing was as to devour the poor secretly.

Persecute.

Psalms 10:2 The wicked in his pride doth persecute the poor: let them be taken in the devices that they have imagined.

Defraud.

Amos 8:5-6 Saying, When will the new moon be gone, that we may sell Corn? and the Sabbath, that we may set forth wheat, making the ephah small, and the shekel great, and falsifying the balances by deceit? 6 That we may buy the poor for silver, and the needy for a pair of shoes; yea, and sell the refuse of the wheat?

Despise the counsel of.

Psalms 14:6 Ye have shamed the counsel of the poor, because the LORD is his refuge.

Guilt of defrauding.

James 5:4 Behold, the hire of the labourers who have reaped down your fields, which is of you kept back by fraud, crieth: and the cries of them which have reaped are entered into the ears of the Lord of sabaoth.

PUNISHMENT FOR

Oppressing.

Proverbs 22:16 He that oppresseth the poor to increase his riches, and he that giveth to the rich, shall surely come to want.

Ezekiel 22:29 The people of the land have used oppression, and exercised robbery, and have vexed the poor and needy: yea, they have oppressed the stranger wrongfully.

Ezekiel 22:31 Therefore have I poured out mine indignation upon them; I have consumed them with the fire of my wrath: their own way have I recompensed upon their heads, saith the Lord GOD.

Spoiling.

Isaiah 3:13-15 The LORD standeth up to plead, and standeth to Judge the people. The LORD will enter into Judgment with the ancients of his people, and the Princes thereof: for ye have eaten up the vineyard; the spoil of the poor is in your houses. What mean ye that ye beat my people to pieces, and grind the faces of the poor? saith the Lord GOD of hosts.

Ezekiel 18:13 Hath given forth upon usury, and hath taken increase: shall he then live? he shall not live: he hath done all these abominations; he shall surely die; his blood shall be upon him.

Refusing to assist.

Job 22:7 Thou hast not given water to the weary to drink, and thou hast withholden bread from the hungry.

Job 22:10 Therefore snares are round about thee, and sudden fear troubleth thee;

Acting unjustly towards.

Job 20:19 Because he hath oppressed and hath forsaken the poor; because he hath violently taken away an house which he builded not;

Job 22:6 For thou hast taken a pledge from thy brother for nought, and stripped the naked of their clothing.

Job 22:10 Therefore snares are round about thee, and sudden fear troubleth thee;

Oppression of Illustrated.

2 Samuel 12:1-6 And the LORD sent Nathan unto David. And he came unto him, and said unto him, There were two men in one city; the one rich, and the other poor. The rich man had exceeding many flocks and herds: But the poor man had nothing, save one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up: and it grew up together with him, and with his children; it did eat of his own meat, and drank of his own cup, and lay in his bosom, and was unto him as a daughter. And there came a traveller unto the rich man, and he spared to take of his own flock and of his own herd, to dress for the wayfaring man that was come unto him; but took the poor man's lamb, and dressed it for the man that was come to him. ...

Care for Illustrated.

Luke 10:33-35 But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him, And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him. And on the morrow when he departed, he took out two pence, and gave them to the host, and said unto him, Take care of him; and whatsoever thou spendest more, when I come again, I will repay thee.

Exemplified.

Gideon,

Judges 6:15 And he said unto him, Oh my Lord, wherewith shall I save Israel? behold, my family is poor in Manasseh, and I am the least in my Father's house.

Ruth,

Ruth 2:2 And Ruth the Moabitess said unto Naomi, Let me now go to the field, and glean ears of Corn after him in whose sight I shall find grace. And she said unto her, Go, my daughter.

Widow of Zarephath,

1 Kings 17:12 And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a Cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.

Prophet's Widow,

2 Kings 4:2 And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.

Saints of old,

Hebrews 11:37 They were stoned, they were sawn asunder, were tempted, were slain with the sword: they wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins; being destitute, Afflicted, tormented;

Regard for Exemplified.

Boaz,

Ruth 2:14 And Boaz said unto her, At mealtime come thou hither, and eat of the bread, and dip thy morsel in the vinegar. And she sat beside the reapers: and he reached her parched Corn, and she did eat, and was sufficed, and left.

Job,

Job 29:12-16 Because I delivered the poor that cried, and the Fatherless, and him that had none to help him. The blessing of him that was ready to perish came upon me: and I caused the widow's heart to Sing for joy. I put on righteousness, and it clothed me: my

Judgment was as a robe and a Diadem. I was eyes to the blind, and feet was I to the lame. ...

Nebuzaradan,

Jeremiah 39:10 But Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard left of the poor of the people, which had nothing, in the land of Judah, and gave them vineyards and fields at the same time.

Zaccheus,

Luke 19:8 And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold.

Peter and John,

Acts 3:6 Then Peter said, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk.

Dorcas,

Acts 9:36 Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named Tabitha, which by interpretation is called Dorcas: this woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did.

Acts 9:39 Then Peter arose and went with them. When he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber: and all the widows stood by him weeping, and shewing the Coats and garments which Dorcas made, while she was with them.

Cornelius,

Acts 10:2 A devout man, and one that feared God with all his house, which gave much Alms to the people, and prayed to God alway.

Church at Antioch,

Acts 11:29-30 Then the disciples, every man according to his Ability, determined to send relief unto the Brethren which dwelt in Judaea: Which also they did, and sent it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

Paul,

Romans 15:25 But now I go unto Jerusalem to minister unto the Saints.

Churches of Macedonia and Achaia,

Romans 15:26 For it hath pleased them of Macedonia and Achaia to make a certain contribution for the poor Saints which are at Jerusalem.

2 Corinthians 8:1-5 Moreover, Brethren, we do you to wit of the grace of God bestowed on the Churches of Macedonia; How that in a great trial of Affliction the Abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their liberality. For to their power, I bear record, yea, and beyond their power they were willing of themselves; Praying us with much intreaty that we would receive the gift, and take upon us the Fellowship of the ministering to the Saints. ...